invasion of India against the British. He was undoubtedly a nationalist hero to many: in 1990-91, the state broadcaster Doordarshan broadcast a historic drama on his life, *The Sword of Tipu Sultan*. Several Kannada plays were written about him in the nineteenth century, and the great playwright Girish Karnad wrote his iconic Kannada–English play, 'Dreams of Tipu Sultan', in 1997 to commemorate fifty years of India's independence. The record shows that Tipu built a strong economy, worked with Hindu advisors and donated to temples. Equally, he was responsible for the killing of thousands of Kodavas in Coorg and the forcible conversion of the Catholic Christians of Mangalore into Islam. For more on this, Chandan Gowda, 'All about Tipu Sultan', *The Hindu*, 2 December 2016, https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/op-ed/All-about-Tipu-Sultan/article16440247.ece. For Girish Karnad's play on Tipu, see Julia Neslie, 'Nailed to the past: Girish Karnad's plays', *Journal of South Asian Literature*, 1996/1997, Vol. 31/32, No. 1/2, pp. 50–84. For a historical account in defence of Tipu, see Bhupendra Yadav, 'Tipu Sultan: Giving "the devil" his due', *Economic & Political Weekly*, Vol. 25, No. 52, 29 December 1990, pp. 2835–2837; Mohammad Moienuddin, 'Distortions of Indian history with reference to Tipu Sultan', *Proceedings of the Indian History Congress*, Part One: Millennium, Vol. 61, 2000–01, pp. 660–666. For more details on Tipu, see William Dalrymple, *The Anarchy: The East India Company, Corporate Violence and the Pillage of an Empire* (London: Bloomsbury, 2019). For the RSS counterview, see, for instance, Prashant Vaidyaraj, '"Historical tyrant" Tipu continues to be eulogised for votes', *Organiser*, 10 November 2018.

42. Manvir Saini, 'BJP win helped RSS grow deep roots in Haryana', *The Times of India*, 5 May 2019, http://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/articleshow/69181307.cms.
43. Ibid.
44. IANS, 'RSS active in 90% of blocks in India: Manmohan Vaidya', *Outlook*, 16 October 2019, https://www.outlookindia.com/newsscroll/rss-active-in-90-of-blocks-in-india-manmohan-vaidya/1641746.
45. Ibid.